



ASUS R2E Versatile But Not A Solid Performer

The ASUS R2E is a handheld ultra mobile PC that is geared towards people on the move. An 800 MHz Intel processor powers the R2E. There is a gigabyte of RAM that powers Windows Vista Home Premium. Although it is supposed to be as portable as possible, the R2E is pretty thick but it weighs way less than most laptops at just 0.83 kg. With a brushed metal finish on the top, it looks pretty.

The touchscreen used is a 7-inch one, but it isn't all that great in terms of colours or even viewing angles. The touch functionality works fine with the stylus. The touch-function isn't very accurate if you use your fingers and is nowhere as good as, say, the iPod Touch. If the touchscreen doesn't suit you, the joystick on the right can be used instead. The mouse click buttons are on the left side of the device. All the buttons are rather large and clunky to use.

An 800 MHz processor is slow, but works perfectly fine for general desktop applications such as MS

Office. Don't expect it to run high-definition video clips and run loads of applications without any stuttering. Vista by itself is a little sluggish on such a configuration. The 4200 RPM 100 GB hard drive is slow, but acceptable for most tasks.

There are many addons



that you get along with the R2E. To compensate for the lack of a keyboard, an external USB keyboard is supplied. The foldable keyboard is still very difficult to use and nowhere as comfortable as even a laptop keyboard. The quality of the keyboard is decent, and when folded,

is very portable. You also get a portable mouse.

An additional battery is supplied as well, which makes the R2E a little fatter but extends the battery-life. The speakers on the device are weak and don't sound all that great. Like on other laptops, connectivity features such as WiFi and Bluetooth are present. A 1.3 MP webcam and even a fingerprint recogniser are built

hands most of the time, this can be very annoying. If things get out of control, the stand on the rear can be used to place it on a table.

The ASUS R2E could have run a version of Windows XP and been a lot more powerful. Still, Vista is well known for its handwriting and touch recognition features, which make it perfect for a product like this.

Targeted at a niche audience, this product is for users who require a computing device that can do much more than a typical business phone, without being as bulky as a laptop. People who want GPS units that go far beyond the ones that sit on your car's dashboard will find the R2E very impressive as well.

Specifications:

Intel 800 MHz processor, 1 GB DDR2 533 MHz RAM, 100 GB 4200 rpm HDD, 7-inch touchscreen, Integrated 802.11b/g

WLAN, 10/100 LAN, Bluetooth, GPS
Dimensions: 23.4 x 13.3 x 2.8 cm, Weight: 0.83 kg.

Contact: ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 18002090365
E-mail: media_india@asus.com
Web site: www.asus.in
Price: Rs 64,900



RATINGS

Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

LG P300 Slimness Personified

When it comes to slim laptops, the new P300 from LG surely is one of the 'top few'. Complete with a glossy top and brushed aluminium finish keyboard, palm-rest and touchpad, this is a product that wants to take on the much hyped Mac Book Air.

The P300 has a 13.3-inch LED backlit LCD display, with a maximum resolution of 1280 x 720. It also sports a 2.1 GHz Intel Core 2 Duo processor, 4 GB of RAM, 250 GB HDD and NVIDIA GeForce 8400m GS graphics to top it up.

The bright 13.3 in display reproduces vibrant and colourful images and is quite visible in brightly light areas. The keyboard is

well spaced, and both the keyboard and touchpad are quite responsive.

This laptop is capable of handling jobs that range from basic Internet browsing, to mid-level computing. The 4 GB RAM really comes in handy when viewing HD videos; plus if you want a bigger screen, the onboard HDMI port will let you hook this laptop up to any HDMI compatible device.

Despite being a compact notebook, the P300 has a plethora of ports. The only thing that was missing from it was a FireWire port. In its place, LG decided to include the "S-Link" port. To be honest, we'd prefer to have the flexibility of a

FireWire port, over a dedicated port for synchronising files.

Even though there are so many pluses to this neat laptop, we would have preferred to have an internal optical drive rather than an external one.

Finally, to sum it all up, the LG P300 comes as a compact notebook that surprises with its performance and features that are enough to take care of your daily computing, and all this as an ultraportable.

Specifications:

Intel Core 2 Duo Processor 2.1 GHz, 4 GB DDR2 Ram, 250 GB HDD, 13.3-inch LED backlit display, Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, External DVD burner.



Contact: LG Electronics India Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 0120-2560900
E-mail: Salvi@lgindia.com
Web site: www.in.lge.com
Price: Rs 75,000

RATINGS

Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

Samsung YP-S2 2 GB A Pebble With Earphones

The all new Samsung YP-S2 is a 2 GB MP3 player that is possibly one of the smallest we've seen. The design resembles ice.

The player has a few buttons on the underside that are used to control the player. There is no display to indicate track number or any other information. The only indication is through a flashing light on the top of the player.

Most of the confusion that new users will find will be due of the lack of a display. Modes are changed by holding down certain buttons, and the display light changes accordingly. Users will need to first look closely through the PDF

manual to understand all of these controls.

The music quality through the supplied earplugs is alright, and there is nothing unexpected from it when played using other earphones. Even though this is such a tiny player, it can easily drive full-sized headphones just fine.

The biggest problem with the YP-S2QB is that it is extremely slow when it comes to transferring files. 500 MB of files took close to 10 minutes and 40 seconds which is atrocious.

The supplied CD contains the manual

for the player and Samsung Media Studio 5. The software is a pretty good media player, syncs with the player and has a whole load of other features such as creating playlists, burning and ripping discs and downloading podcasts. The price for this 2 GB player is just Rs 2,750 which it makes it pretty affordable, even though it doesn't have all the features of a typical compact PMP such as an FM tuner, for example. If you want more in

terms of features, spend a couple of hundreds more and

you will have many to choose from.

Specifications:

Memory Capacity: 2 GB, Formats Supported: MP3, WMA, OGG

Contact: Samsung India Electronics Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 011-41511234
E-mail: jitender.c@samsung.com
Web site: www.samsung.com/in
Price: Rs 2,750

RATINGS

Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

